

Career Oriented Travel Guidance 2025-2026

Purpose & Context:

Simon encourages student-led travel for career exploration. This guidance outlines a three-tiered system to help students and clubs plan meaningful, structured travel experiences—with appropriate expectations for staff involvement and support.

- All treks must follow the formal proposal and approval process.
 - Complete the proposal and follow specified protocols.
 - Staff presence is not guaranteed and depends on existing Simon business travel (e.g., a national conference, a UR or Simon-hosted alumni event, or a major employer engagement)
 - Our goal is to **empower students with resources and guidance**, even when staff cannot attend.
-

Three Support Tiers for Career-Related Travel

Tier 1: Career Treks (Staff-Supported & School-Aligned)

These are career treks that **align with Simon or University of Rochester business needs** and may be eligible for staff support if staff are already traveling for related purposes.

Examples of eligible alignment:

- Simon or UR-hosted alumni/employer events
- National conferences (e.g., NMBAA, ROMBA)
- Cities where Benet Center staff already have scheduled meetings

Requirements & Notes:

- Staff attendance is **not guaranteed**—only considered if it overlaps with institutional travel.
- Students must submit a formal proposal, outline goals, and attend preparation meetings.
- Final approval comes from the **Assistant Dean of the Benet Center**, with input from other Simon leadership if needed.

Support Provided by Benet:

- Alumni and employer contacts
- Outreach templates and best practices
- One-on-one coaching

Club Responsibilities:

- All logistics, planning, and expenses are managed by students
- Use of club funds may be requested through proper channels
- A Simon staff coach (e.g., club advisor) must be identified

Deliverables:

- A written trip plan (itinerary, costs, company and alumni visits)
- Post-trip written reflection and feedback
- De-brief meeting with the coach within 10 days of the trek

Tier 2: Club Group Experience (No Staff Travel, Resource-Supported)

These are club-organized treks that **do not align with institutional travel priorities** but still offer valuable career exploration opportunities.

Support Provided by Benet:

- Alumni and employer contacts
- Outreach templates and best practices
- One-on-one coaching

Club Responsibilities:

- All logistics, planning, and expenses are managed by students
- Use of club funds may be requested through proper channels
- A Simon staff coach (e.g., club advisor) must be identified

Deliverables:

- A written trip plan (itinerary, costs, company and alumni visits)
- Post-trip written reflection and feedback
- De-brief meeting with the Simon staff coach within 10 days of the trek

Tier 3: Individual or Small Group Travel (Fully Student-Led)

This includes student-initiated visits for **company tours, informational interviews, or career research**.

Support Provided:

- Same guidance as Tier 2 (templates, outreach support, coaching)
- **No use of club funds or staff travel** allowed

Important Considerations & Best Practices

- **Company Readiness:** The Benet Center may advise against visits to companies experiencing hiring freezes, layoffs, or those unable to host students. Benet CMC can help redirect efforts toward more fruitful opportunities.
- **Virtual Options:** When in-person travel isn't feasible, virtual treks can offer strong alternatives. The Benet Center is happy to support or co-host these sessions.
- **Cost & Inclusion:** Out-of-pocket costs can be significant. We encourage clubs to plan treks that are financially accessible to all members.